

Every edit stops the playtest

THE USER

Technical designers at small studios iterate on playable prototypes with real playtesters in the room.

THE COST

Every stop costs the thing they are trying to observe: how people actually play.

Beetle's promise

Change the game without stopping the game.

TODAY'S LOOP



Each turn of the loop loses the live playtest you were trying to watch.

Any game, one prompt, then keep changing it while they play



1

Any game request

"king of the hill on a frozen arena, hold ten seconds"

2

Mapped to the closest mode and biome

the agent fills the parameters and says which it chose

3

Starts where the players are

the brief builds the spawn zone

4

Grows as they move

every extension a small patch, validated before it lands

5

Keep changing it while they play

mode, biome, speed, bridges, hazard; no reset

MODE LIBRARY (ENGINE MECHANICS, NOT MODEL-WRITTEN RULES)

Mode	What players do	Win condition	Parameters (contract ranges)
relic_hunt	collect relics over the bridges, enter the gate	gate unlocks after relicsRequired relics; a player reaches it	relicsRequired 1 to 3 (default all)
time_trial	the same relic hunt against a clock	finish before timeLimitSec; lost when it expires	timeLimitSec 20 to 600 s (default 120)
king_of_the_hill	reach the gate island (the hill) and stand in its zone	first player whose held time reaches holdSeconds	holdSeconds 3 to 60 s (default 10)
checkpoint_race	reach the relics as checkpoints, in order, then the gate	every checkpoint, then the gate	orderedCheckpoints; at least 2 relics
survival	grab a relic and reach the gate while the hazard rises and bridges submerge	relic plus gate before timeLimitSec; lost when it expires	hazard.rise afterSec, metersPerSec, maxElevation; timeLimitSec

Biomes garden, volcanic, frost, desert, night. **Hazard and pace** water or lava, a rising hazard, 3 to 7 m/s, 11 decoration types. **Changed live, no reset** set_mode, set_biome, set_movement and the structural ops, each validated and committed as a new version. **Streaming** extends the world ahead of players near an edge, up to 24 islands and 48 bridges; the director can switch it off.

Adapted from one-prompt game generators: the one-prompt front door and instant playable output. Added: live editing without a reset, deterministic validation and repair before publish, local-only inference, phones as controllers (docs/COMPETITIVE.md). A request outside the library lands on the nearest mode and the agent says so.

The working video



[VIDEO PLACEHOLDER]

Insert the rehearsal recording here (90 to 120 s). Not yet recorded at 13:40 CDT.

The caption names the agent mode used; any time compression is labelled on screen

ON-SCREEN CAPTIONS

0 to 6 s Beetle. Change the game without stopping the game.

6 to 22 s A local model composes the world. Validated by game code before it is published.

22 to 34 s Two players join from their phones. Same screen, their phones only send controls.

34 to 58 s Edits land live. No disconnect, no reset.

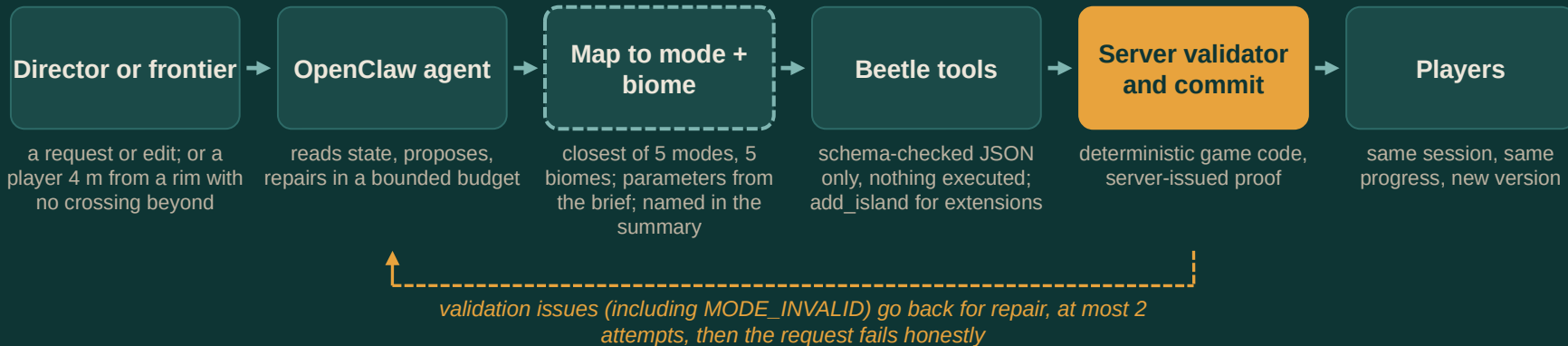
58 to 90 s The validator refuses a world nobody can finish (DISCONNECTED_GOAL). The agent repairs it and commits only a passing version.

90 to 105 s Measured on one GB10. Local model, local agent in [direct or OpenClaw] mode, no cloud.

105 to 115 s Beetle

Fresh world, two phones, a live edit, preserved progress, a conflicting edit caught by the validator, the repaired version committed.

Agent architecture and validation



TWO KINDS OF STATE

- WorldSpec is structure: islands, bridges, mode, biome, movement, hazard. One version per committed transaction.
- SessionState is players, relics, score and the mode objective. The simulation advances it; the agent never writes it.
- Commit needs a server-issued proof.

VALIDATION IS GAME CODE

- Geometry, bridge sockets, walk field, reachability with the gate locked, occupied support at commit time.
- `MODE_INVALID`: relics required above the count, a race with under 2 checkpoints, survival without a rising hazard, a timer outside 20 to 600 s.
- An LLM saying valid is never approval.

GROWS AHEAD OF PLAYERS

- Frontier trigger: a player within 4 m of a rim with no crossing beyond; at least 12 s between extensions.
- Beetle opens the request itself (marked auto); the agent answers with add_island, 1 to 2 islands, each bridged from an anchor.
- Same validator and commit. Stops at 24 islands, 48 bridges; director toggle.

Measured local-first results



MODEL

qwen3.5:4b, Q4_K_M

4.7B, 3.4 GB, Ollama 0.35.1 on loopback.
qwen3.8:27b not benchmarked: pull failed
once, second pull stopped.
docs/MODEL_SELECTION.md

BRIEF, WARM, QUIET GPU

26.2 / 26.5 / 27.7 s

min / p50 / max, 3 runs, first draft valid
(bench-...1791049348895.json). 10 s target
not met. 14 s once after normalization
(RESULTS.md run 3); 33.4 s via OpenClaw.

MODE BRIEFS

18 of 18 right mode

committed briefs 13.0 to 44.1 s; exact mode
missed twice; 8 of 14 final-prompt attempts
committed, failures all geometry; mode and
biome edits 3.0 s (RESULTS.md 'Game
modes from one prompt', direct).

COLD / CONTENTED GPU

23.1 s load; 58 to 214 s

cold: 23.1 s load in a 54.4 s first draft (probe-
run.log). Contended drafts 58.8 to 214.1 s,
one edit 45.1 s
(bench-...1791050596040.json).

EDIT TO COMMIT

2.0 / 8.0 / 14.0 s

min / p50 / max, 6 edits, 5 of 6 committed;
run 3 after normalization, quiet GPU, direct
(run-1791052136845.json). Run 2 before: 2
of 6.

EDIT WHILE 2 PLAY

8.0 s, 15 of 15

acceptance run 2: both controllers walking,
lava + bridge committed, relic and score
unchanged, sockets open, max tick gap 67
ms (ACCEPTANCE.md).

INVALID EDITS CAUGHT

6 of 12 refused

runs 2 and 3 (RESULTS.md); repairs that
then committed: 1; invalid worlds committed:
0. garden5: DISCONNECTED_GOAL
refused 1.7 s, repaired and committed 3.0 s.

NORMALIZATION EFFECT

2 of 30 to 13 of 30

corpus validity without vs with the
deterministic normalizer
(MODEL_FAILURE_MODES.md). Live edits
committed: 2 of 6 to 5 of 6.

OPENCLAW LIVE

20.0 s edit, 33.4 s brief

real tool calls, v2 at 13:43 CDT; brief to v1 at
14:08 CDT; gated test 38.9 s, 7 tool calls
(RESULTS.md, BUILD_STATUS.md 17).

LATENCY, LOOPBACK

0.56 ms RTT, 0.80 ms tick

p50 idle, scripted controllers (p95 1.01 and
1.10 ms; under 2 x 30 inputs/s tick p95 50.2
ms; LATENCY.md 20:10Z). Not input to
photon.

PHONES

not yet with devices

controller page under mobile emulation and
23 integration tests with real sockets pass
(BUILD_STATUS.md 12); no physical phone
joined today.

OFFLINE PROOF

not run

only a before record exists
(offline-proof/1791049273707.json: egress
not blocked, server not up). Procedure:
docs/OFFLINE_PROOF.md. Nothing
claimed.

Streaming generation: implemented. One live run: extension committed 9.5 s after the frontier trigger, player preserved (RESULTS.md 15:16 CDT, direct, quiet GPU). Acceptance numbers to follow.

Direct-harness timings are labelled [direct] in every report; OpenClaw timings are from the real server after the Ollama daemon restart at 13:43 CDT. Each card names its GPU state because the daemon was shared for most of the day. Mode briefs were measured at 14:25 to 14:42 CDT in direct mode with no controllers connected (docs/RESULTS.md).

Business hypothesis and next validation



HYPOTHESIS

- Studios will pay for faster prototype iteration that keeps playtests running.
- Their data stays on their machines, which matters to studios with unreleased IP.

NOT CLAIMED

- Market size.
- Pricing.
- Customer traction.
- Speed-up percentages without a measured baseline.

NEXT VALIDATION

- Time a conventional edit-rebuild-regather loop with the same designers and the same change list.
- Compare it against Beetle's measured edit-to-commit times.



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